WORKSHEET PACK

Powered Buildings

How Real Estate Pros Find, Qualify and Broker Small AI Data Center Deals

1 Building Scorecard

2 First-Call Script and Question Lists

3 Vendor Bench Checklist

4 The Thirty-Day Plan

5 State Questions Worksheet

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These are the five worksheets from the back of the book, set on letter paper with room to write. Print as many copies as you need. They are education only. They are not legal, engineering or investment advice, and nothing on them states capacity, feasibility, value or a pass.

WORKSHEET 1 OF 5

Building Scorecard

One sheet for each building. Copy this page.

> **Read before you score.** This is a first-look screen for an existing building that might suit a 1 to 10 MW data center. It ranks your list. It does not approve a building, and it does not replace the utility's written answer or a licensed engineer's finding. The weights, the cut points and the score bands are my estimates. They have no published source and have not been tested.

Building: _____ **Parcel no.:** _____ **Date:** _____

Serving utility (and source): _____ **Scored by:** _____

How to rate

Give each of the eleven lines one rating.

Rating	Meaning	Counts as
Good	The evidence meets the "good" description	The full weight
Maybe	In between, or a clue without confirmation	Half the weight
No-go	The evidence meets the "no-go" description	Zero
Unknown	You do not have the facts yet	Zero for now. Write U.

Write the evidence and its source beside every rating. A rating with no evidence is "unknown".

Gate 1. Power

1. Utility capacity, in writing (hard gate)

Weight 25

Good	Maybe	No-go
The utility confirms in writing 5 MW or more of total site load at this address, today or by a stated date	The utility confirms 1 to 5 MW in writing. Or a large service is installed and the utility has not yet answered	The utility states in writing that less than 1 MW is available, with no upgrade path or date

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 25

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

2. Installed service

Weight 10

Good	Maybe	No-go
5,000 kVA or more on the nameplates, or a substation on site that serves this parcel	1,500 to 5,000 kVA	Under 1,500 kVA

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 10

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

3. Distance to a substation of the serving utility

Weight 8

Good	Maybe	No-go
On site or next door, about a quarter mile or less	Within about 2 miles	More than about 2 miles, and no large service installed

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 8

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Notes for this gate:

- Line 1 is total site load, not IT load.

- Line 2 measures equipment. kVA = 1.732 × volts × amps ÷ 1,000 for a three-phase service. kVA is not kW without power factor. A nameplate is not a promise from the utility. Do not add two services together.
- Line 3 is a clue about the work to connect. A nearby substation proves neither service nor spare capacity. Record which map you used and its date.

Gate 2. Permits

4. Zoning (hard gate) — Weight 10

Good	Maybe	No-go
The code lists the use, or a use that plainly covers it, as allowed by right in this district	The use needs a special or conditional approval. Or the code does not name it and staff must interpret	The use is prohibited, or a recorded restriction blocks it

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 10

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

5. Flood designation — Weight 5

Good	Maybe	No-go
Building and yard outside the mapped Special Flood Hazard Area	Part of the yard is in a mapped flood hazard area, or the area is mapped as moderate risk	The building itself is in a mapped Special Flood Hazard Area

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 5

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

6. Neighbors and water		Weight 4
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
Industrial or vacant neighbors, and a cooling design that uses little water	Homes in sight but buffered by distance or a road. Or water use not yet known	Homes or a school at the property line. Or a design that needs a large new water withdrawal

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 4

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Notes for this gate:

- Line 4: copy the exact words of the listed use from the code.
- Line 5: a flood designation is a flag for review, not a rejection. A "no-go" here scores zero on this line. It does not fail the building.
- Line 6: low water use is not an automatic exemption from any permit.

Gate 3. Structure

7. Floor type and the engineer's finding (hard gate)		Weight 12
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
A licensed structural engineer has reviewed the floor and the delivery path for the intended rack layout and found them suitable, in writing	Slab on grade, not yet reviewed. Or an elevated floor awaiting an engineer's review	A licensed structural engineer has found the floor unsuitable and strengthening not feasible

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 12

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

8. Clear height		Weight 5
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
16 feet or more	12 to 16 feet	Under 12 feet

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 5

Evidence, source and date _____

Notes for this gate:

- Line 7 asks two things: what kind of floor is it, and what has an engineer found? Write the floor type and the source. Do not write a pounds-per-square-foot figure as a pass or a fail. A floor's code design load cannot be compared with a rack's weight to pass or fail a building.
- Until an engineer has reported, the best rating on line 7 is "maybe". Only an engineer's finding makes it "good" or "no-go".
- Line 8: ask each buyer for its own minimum.

Gate 4. Cooling

9. Yard for cooling and generators (hard gate)		Weight 10
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
Open yard the owner controls on two or more sides, with truck access and no homes adjoining	Yard on one side only. Or equipment would have to go on a roof that an engineer must check	No yard the owner controls, and an engineer has found no workable roof or other route

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 10

Evidence, source and date _____

Note for this gate: a mechanical engineer sizes the plant. You are recording whether there is anywhere to put it.

Gate 5. Connectivity

10. Fiber carriers and routes		Weight 7
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
Two or more carriers confirm fiber to the building, entering by different routes	One carrier with fiber. Or two that may share a route. Or map listings and markers only	Carriers confirm no fiber at or near the address

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 7

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Note for this gate: the FCC map reports mass-market internet service. A listing does not prove data center connectivity, and a missing listing does not prove there is no fiber. Only a carrier's written response makes this line "good" or "no-go".

After the gates. The owner

11. Owner and title		Weight 4
Good	**Maybe**	**No-go**
One decision maker, open to a sale or a lease, who shares bills and drawings	Interested but slow. Several owners. Or wants a price before facts	A title dispute. Another party already holds rights. Or the owner will share nothing

Rating ☐ Good ☐ Maybe ☐ No-go ☐ Unknown Points _____ of 4

Evidence, source and date _____

_____

Questions to carry

For the owner

- Can we read the main switchgear and transformer nameplates together?
- Can I see electric bills from the busiest year, showing peak demand?
- Do you have the original structural drawings or a slab report?
- What was the heaviest equipment on this floor, and did it have its own foundation?
- Which outdoor areas are inside your property line and free of easements?

- Are there recorded use restrictions, easements or covenants on the parcel?
- Has the building or yard ever flooded?
- Which carriers have equipment in your telecom room?
- Who else has to agree before you can sell or lease?

For the utility, from the owner or with the owner's written permission

- What capacity can you serve at this address today without new construction?
- What would it take, and how long, to serve the amount we need?
- Which substation and feeder serve this address?

For a buyer

- Is your megawatt figure IT load or total site load?
- What minimum clear height do you need?
- Does your cooling design evaporate water?
- Which network hub must the site reach?

Score

Sum of (weight × rating value) for all eleven lines	_____ out of 100
Number of lines rated Unknown	_____
Any hard gate (lines 1, 4, 7, 9) rated No-go?	Yes / No

How to read it. These bands are my estimates.

- **A hard gate rated no-go:** the building fails that gate, whatever the total. Write down the reason and the source.
- **75 or more:** a strong candidate. Next: the utility's answer in writing, and engineers.
- **50 to 74:** worth a site visit. Next: resolve every "maybe", starting with power.
- **Under 50:** set aside for now. Keep it on a second list.

Always report the score with the count of unknowns. A low score with many unknowns means you do not have the facts yet. It does not mean the building is poor. At a desk, lines 1, 7 and 10 can rarely be better than "maybe", so a first score is usually low.

Do not turn the result into a count of problems. One fatal problem can end a project. Several fixable ones need not.

> **This score is not an approval.** Nothing on this page states capacity, feasibility, value or a pass. The serving utility confirms power in writing. Licensed engineers decide what the building can carry and cool. Local officials decide what is permitted.

WORKSHEET 2 OF 5

First-Call Script and Question Lists

Print or copy. These come from chapter 9, "The Walk and the Owner Call". Chapter 4 covers the owner's full written inquiry to the utility.

Read this first. This is education, not legal, engineering or safety advice. The script and the lists are the author's recommendations and come from no published source. Put the script in your own words. Follow your broker's policies and your state's rules on prospecting calls, including any do-not-call procedure. On the owner's property, follow the owner's rules. Do not open or touch electrical equipment, and do not enter an electrical room alone.

Page 1. The ninety-second owner script

The only goal of this call: a site visit and one electric bill.

Before you dial:

- ☐ The building has been through the ten-minute screen. Result: visit or unknown.
- ☐ My broker knows which building I am calling about.
- ☐ I checked whether another brokerage has the listing.
- ☐ I followed my office's calling rules.

1. Who you are

> "Hello, is this _____? My name is _____. I am a commercial real estate agent with _____ in _____. Do you have two minutes?"

2. Why them

> "I am calling about your building on _____. It came up in my research in the public records, because of what it was built for. I am not calling with an offer, and I do not have a buyer."

3. The reason to listen

> "It has been reported that some companies running artificial intelligence computers are looking for capacity at existing sites that already have power. I am studying which buildings in our area might deserve a closer look. Most will not fit. I do not know yet about yours."

4. The ask

> "I would like twenty minutes with you at the building. I would like to see the main electrical room with you, without opening anything, and one electric bill from a year when the building was running at full production."

5. No pressure

> "Afterward I will tell you what I saw, and which questions only your utility and an engineer can answer. If it does not look like a fit, I will tell you why, and it will have cost you twenty minutes. Would _____ or _____ work?"

Do not say

- A price.
- "I have a buyer," unless you do.
- Any number of megawatts.
- That the building "works", "fits" or "is ready".

If the owner says no: "Would it be all right if I sent you a one-page note about what I was looking for, in case it is ever useful?" Send it. Leave them alone.

If the owner starts talking: let them. Take notes.

Visit set for: _____ Bill offered: yes / no Notes written same day: ☐

Page 2. Questions for the owner

Ask two or three on the phone. Bring the rest to the visit. Write the answer, the date and who said it.

The building's history

- [ ] What was made or done here, and when did full operation stop?
- [ ] Is the building in use, leased or vacant today? Any plans for it?

Power

- [ ] Which electric utility serves you? Is the account active?
- [ ] Could I see bills from a busy year? Twelve months if you have them.
- [ ] Is there a single-line diagram or any electrical drawings?
- [ ] Is there a substation or large transformer on the site? Who owns it, you or the utility?
- [ ] Was any electrical equipment removed when operations stopped?
- [ ] Are there generators? What do they back up?

Structure and site

- [ ] Do you have the original structural drawings, especially the slab and foundations?
- [ ] Did any heavy machines sit on their own foundations? Were pits filled later?
- [ ] Has water ever stood in the yard or come into the building?
- [ ] Do you have a survey or a site plan?

Fiber

- [ ] Who provides internet and phone service? Was there ever a second provider?

Environment and title

- [ ] Are there any environmental reports?
- [ ] Is there a mortgage, lien, easement or recorded restriction on use?
- [ ] Who else owns the property with you? Who would have to agree to a sale or lease?
- [ ] Has anyone else approached you? Does anyone hold an option or an agreement?

The relationship

- [ ] Do you already work with a broker or an attorney on this property?

Documents to leave on the owner's list

- [ ] Electric bills from a full-production year.

- [ ] Single-line diagram and electrical drawings.
- [ ] Original structural drawings, and drawings of later changes.
- [ ] Survey or site plan.
- [ ] Roof information: age, and anything mounted on it.
- [ ] Environmental reports.
- [ ] Generator and fuel tank records.
- [ ] Telecom contracts or drawings showing where cables enter.
- [ ] Any letters from the utility about the service.

If a document does not exist, write "does not exist".

The sentence for the bill

> "A bill from _____ shows a peak demand of _____ kW. That is what the building drew then. It is not what the utility will serve today."

The sentence for the nameplate

> "Main switchgear nameplate: _____ volts, _____ amps. Utility capacity not confirmed."

Page 3. Questions for the utility

These go out from the owner, or from you with the owner's written permission. They are the first questions. Chapter 4 lists what a full written inquiry contains.

Sent by: _____ Date sent: _____ Written permission on file: ☐

- ☐ What service is installed at this address today, and is the account active?
- ☐ Is any capacity still committed to this site?
- ☐ How much can you serve here now, at the meter, without new construction?
- ☐ What would be needed to serve _____ MW, and by when?
- ☐ Who would pay for that work? Is there a study fee or a deposit?
- ☐ At what voltage would you serve a load of that size?
- ☐ Does your answer reserve capacity, and for how long?
- ☐ Who is the right contact for a request like this?
- ☐ Please reply in writing.

The amount in the blank is the owner's decision, made with a buyer's requirement or an engineer's advice in hand. Ask for what the building and its yard can really use.

When the reply comes, record five things

- ☐ The amount, and whether it is stated at the meter.
- ☐ The date, and anything it depends on.
- ☐ The conditions: what has to be built, and by whom.
- ☐ The cost: study fee, contribution, deposit.
- ☐ The shelf life: whether the reply reserves anything, and for how long.

Until that reply is in the file, the page says: **"Utility capacity not confirmed."**

WORKSHEET 3 OF 5

Vendor Bench Checklist

Print or copy. This is chapter 12's bench as a table.

The owner or the buyer chooses, hires and pays every person on this page. You introduce. No single conversion needs every role. This checklist works in any state. The "where to verify" column is the worked example: Florida. It was read on 2026-11-11 and is not legal advice. In your state, find that state's agency for each license, using the lookup pattern on the State Questions Worksheet, and write it over the Florida entry. "None read" means I read no Florida license for that role as such. It does not mean no license applies. What the person actually does decides that.

Building: _____ **State and county:** _____ **Date started:** _____

Designers and site specialists

Electrical engineer		
What they answer	**When to call**	**License to verify, and where (Florida)**
What the building can do with the power the utility delivers; whether old equipment can be reused	First technical look, or earlier to help frame the utility inquiry	Professional engineer. Florida Board of Professional Engineers licensee search; DBPR also lists "Engineers"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Mechanical engineer

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
How much heat must leave the building, with what plant, and where it goes	First technical look	Professional engineer. Same

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Structural engineer

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Whether the floor, the delivery path and the roof can carry the loads	First technical look, before anyone says the floor works	Professional engineer. Same

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Civil engineer

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Drainage, paving, grading and yard pads	Design, or earlier if the yard floods or is tight	Professional engineer. Same

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Geotechnical engineer, if needed

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
What is under the slab and the yard	When the structural or civil engineer asks	Professional engineer. Same. DBPR also lists "Geologists"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Surveyor

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Where the boundary, easements and improvements really are	Before a contract relies on yard area	Surveyor and mapper, chapter 472. Department of Agriculture and Consumer Services

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Environmental consultant (Phase I ESA)

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Whether past use left contamination	Before a purchase closes; the buyer's attorney and lender set the scope	Ask how the person meets the federal "environmental professional" definition (40 CFR 312.10). If it rests on a PE or geologist license, verify that license

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Fiber or low-voltage contractor

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Which carriers reach the building, by which routes; who installs cabling inside	Carrier survey once a buyer is interested; installation during construction	Ask which electrical or alarm license covers the scope. DBPR, "Electrical Contractors"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Utility or energy consultant

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
How to frame the load inquiry, read the tariff and compare rates	Before the inquiry, if the owner wants help	None read. Verify any engineer's license claimed

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Data center consultant or owner's representative

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
What a buyer will expect; whether the project stays on scope and schedule	When the owner commits money to design	None read. Verify any engineer's or contractor's license claimed. See chapter 11 on what this role may not do

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Commissioning agent

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Whether the finished systems work together as designed	Named during design; tests at the end	None read. Verify any engineer's license claimed

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Legal, title, money and risk

Land use or zoning attorney

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
The approval path, who decides, and the risks	When the code is unclear or a special approval is needed	Attorney. The Florida Bar, "Find a Lawyer"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Real estate attorney

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
The contract, the lease or the venture agreement	Before the owner signs anything with a buyer	Attorney. Same

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Title company

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Who owns the property; liens, easements and restrictions	Early in a contract	Title insurance agent. Department of Financial Services licensee search, category "Title"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Insurance broker

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
What coverage the building, the work and the operation need	When a flood flag appears; again before construction	Insurance agent. Department of Financial Services licensee search

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Appraiser

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
A formal opinion of value	When a lender or a party requires one	Certified or licensed real estate appraiser. DBPR, "Real Estate Appraisers"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Lender or capital source

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Whether the project can be financed, and on what conditions	When a buyer or developer is serious	Not read. Ask the party's attorney

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Permit expediter

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Which permits are needed, in what order, and where an application stands	Design, where permitting is complicated	None read

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Broker who has closed a data center deal

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
How these deals are actually written and closed	When a real buyer requirement arrives; through your own broker	Real estate broker. DBPR, "Real Estate"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Builders

General contractor

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
What the whole job costs and how it will be run	Budget pricing during design; contract after permits are in view	General contractor (a building contractor's license is narrower). DBPR, "Construction Industry"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Electrical contractor

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
How the service, distribution and generator connections get installed	Pricing during design; installation	Electrical contractor. DBPR, "Electrical Contractors"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Mechanical or HVAC contractor

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
How the cooling plant and piping get installed	Pricing during design; installation	Mechanical or air-conditioning contractor. DBPR, "Construction Industry"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Plumber

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
Water supply, drains, and piping within the plumbing scope	Design and installation	Plumbing contractor. DBPR, "Construction Industry"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Fire sprinkler contractor

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
How the suppression system gets installed	Design, with the fire protection engineer; installation	Fire protection system contractor, chapter 633. Division of State Fire Marshal, Regulatory Licensing

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Fire alarm contractor

What they answer	When to call	License to verify, and where (Florida)
How detection and alarm get installed	Same	Alarm system contractor; ask whether another electrical license also covers the scope. DBPR, "Electrical Contractors"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Roofing contractor		
What they answer	**When to call**	**License to verify, and where (Florida)**
The roof's condition; how openings and rooftop loads get sealed	First technical look if the roof is old; again before equipment goes up	Roofing contractor. DBPR, "Construction Industry"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

Security contractor		
What they answer	**When to call**	**License to verify, and where (Florida)**
Fencing, access control and cameras to the buyer's written standard	Design, once the buyer's standard is known	Ask which license covers the scope; alarm systems fall under the alarm system contractor license. DBPR, "Electrical Contractors"

1. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

2. Name and firm _____ Phone _____

License no., date checked, notes _____

How to check a license

- ☐ Ask for the license number.
- ☐ Look it up at the regulator, not on the firm's own website.
- ☐ Read the record: active, the right kind for this work, and in the name of the firm that will sign.
- ☐ Write the license number and the date you checked in the last column.
- ☐ Give the owner the record, not a recommendation.

Before you hand this to an owner

- [ ] Two names for each role the building needs, where I could find two.
- [ ] Nothing on this page recommends one firm over another.
- [ ] I have asked my broker and an attorney before accepting anything of value from anyone listed.

WORKSHEET 4 OF 5

The Thirty-Day Plan

Print or copy. This is chapter 13 as a checklist.

> This is a planning target. It is not a forecast of a deal, a listing or a fee. The day numbers and list sizes are my suggestions. **An inquiry under way is not a qualified building.**

Start date: _____ **Broker told on:** _____

Before day one

- ☐ My broker knows what I am doing and how the brokerage wants these listings handled.
- ☐ I have started my state's answers to the ten licensing questions (see the State Questions worksheet).
- ☐ A daily slot is blocked on my calendar.
- ☐ One folder for each building, and one sheet with a row for each building and a column for each gate.

Week 1. List and desk screens

- ☐ Day 1: long list of ten to twenty parcels from public records, each with its source and date.
- ☐ Days 2 and 3: the ten-minute screen on every parcel. One line for each gate: what I know, what I do not know, who can tell me.
- ☐ Every parcel has a result: stop, visit or unknown.
- ☐ Day 4: top five ranked. A Building Scorecard sheet started for each.
- ☐ Day 5: top five photographed from public roads only.
- ☐ My state's license search pages found and bookmarked: engineers, contractors, fire protection.
- ☐ Nothing on any sheet claims capacity, approval or a pass.

Friday counts: buildings screened _____ owner conversations _____ facts confirmed in writing

Week 2. Owner calls and one walk

- ☐ Days 6 and 7: owner names and mailing addresses for the top five. First-call script practiced out loud.

- [ ] Days 8 and 9: all five owners called. Dates noted. Second call placed where needed.
- [ ] Day 10: one building walked, with the owner present.
- [ ] No equipment opened. No electrical room entered alone.
- [ ] Nameplates, yard, docks and delivery path photographed.
- [ ] Asked for: a bill from a full-production year, the single-line diagram, structural drawings.
- [ ] Scorecard sheet updated the same day, with evidence and source on every line.
- [ ] Red flags sorted by severity, not counted.
- [ ] Open questions listed, each with the person who can answer it.

Friday counts: buildings screened _____ owner conversations _____ facts confirmed in writing

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Week 3. The owner's utility inquiry and the first introductions

- [ ] Day 11: one building chosen. Reason written down.
- [ ] Days 12 and 13: written load inquiry prepared with the owner. It asks for the reply in writing.
- [ ] Inquiry sent by the owner, or by me with the owner's written permission. Date sent: _____
- [ ] Days 14 and 15: each open technical question matched to a discipline on my bench.
- [ ] Two names offered to the owner for each, with the license record and the date I checked.
- [ ] The owner decides whom to hire, and hires them directly.
- [ ] No contact with a utility or a planner that the owner did not authorize.
- [ ] Owners from week 2 who did not answer: called again.

Friday counts: buildings screened _____ owner conversations _____ facts confirmed in writing

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Week 4. The fact file and the brokerage agreement

- [ ] Days 16 to 18: two-page fact file written. Five sections, one for each gate. Each has what is known, what is not known and who can answer.
- [ ] Attachments: parcel record, zoning text, flood map panel, nameplate photographs, bill, drawings, scorecard sheet.
- [ ] Every fact has a source and a date.

- [ ] No sentence states capacity. No sentence says pass, approved or ready.
- [ ] Day 19: brokerage agreement reviewed with my broker. It names the fee, who owes it, the earning event for a sale, a lease, a ground lease and a joint venture, the due date and the term.
- [ ] Day 20: the owner has the file and has said who else may see it.

Friday counts: buildings screened _____ owner conversations _____ facts confirmed in writing

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On day 30 I have

- [ ] A screened list of ten to twenty buildings.
- [ ] Owners who know my name and what I do.
- [ ] One building with facts on all five gates and a list of open questions.
- [ ] A utility inquiry under way, if the owner agreed.
- [ ] A bench with names and license records.
- [ ] My role in writing, or a dated note of where that stands.

Rules that do not bend

- [ ] No promise of a buyer, a price or a timeline.
- [ ] No contact with a utility or a planner about an owner's parcel without the owner's permission.
- [ ] Installed equipment and confirmed utility capacity stay in separate sentences.
- [ ] No payment to an unlicensed person for a lead, until I have checked my state's rule.
- [ ] No brokerage money outside the way my state requires it to flow.
- [ ] Every number carries its source and its date.
- [ ] The owner hires the experts.
- [ ] No building is called qualified until the utility has answered in writing and licensed engineers have looked.

After day 30

- [ ] Start weeks 1 and 2 again on a second batch.
- [ ] When the utility answers, read the answer with the owner and write its conditions into the fact file word for word.

- [ ] Re-check any fact that has gone stale before relying on it.
- [ ] When a real buyer requirement arrives, call a broker who has closed one.

WORKSHEET 5 OF 5

State Questions Worksheet

Use this in any state. Copy this page. Fill it in for the state where the building sits.

This worksheet works in any state. Licensing, utility regulation and permitting are state and local law. Florida is this book's worked example, and a few named sources for Texas, Georgia, Virginia, Ohio and Arizona are in the "Other states" boxes in chapters 4, 11 and 12. Everything else you look up yourself, here. These are the questions to ask. They are not answers, and this page is not legal advice. Write down who answered, and when. Rules change.

State: _____ **County or city:** _____ **Started on:** _____

How to find the official source in any state

Use the same four steps for every question on this page.

1. **Start at the government's own website.** The state legislature for statutes. The board or commission for a license. The utility commission for dockets and tariffs. The county or city for zoning and permits.
2. **Use the search the agency itself runs.** For a license it is usually called "license lookup", "verify a license" or "roster". For a tariff it is the utility's "rates and tariffs" page or the commission's docket search.
3. **Copy the words and the citation.** Write the section number, the page title and the date you read it.
4. **Then ask a person.** Take what you read to your broker, the agency's staff or an attorney in that state. What you read is a starting point. It is not a legal conclusion.

Which office to ask

What you need	Kind of office to ask	What to search for on its website
Who must hold a real estate license to earn a fee	State real estate commission or board; your broker	"license law"
Whether a real estate license is active	State real estate commission or board	"license lookup" or "verify a license"
Whether an engineer is licensed	State board of professional engineers	"roster" or "licensee search"

What you need	Kind of office to ask	What to search for on its website
Whether a contractor is licensed	State contractor board; if the state has none for that trade, the local building department	"contractor search"
Large-load or data center tariffs	State public utility or public service commission; the serving utility	"large load", "data center", "tariff book"
Who serves the address	The serving utility's new-service or business desk	"service territory map"
Building code edition	City or county building official	"adopted codes"
Zoning and use	City or county planning office	"zoning map", "use table"
Water permits	State environmental agency or regional water district	"water use permit"
Parcel records	County assessor, appraiser or auditor	"property search"

Part 1. The ten licensing questions (chapter 11)

Take these to your broker, your state's real estate regulator and an attorney.

About brokerage

#	Question	Answer	Date	Who answered (name and role)
1	How does my state define brokerage activity? Does pay have to depend on a closing?			
2	How must my compensation flow? Through my broker only?			
3	May I, or my broker, pay a referral fee to an unlicensed person? To a licensee in another state?			
4	What may an out-of-state licensee do on a property in my state? What may I do on a property in another state?			
5	What does my state require when I advertise a property feature I have not verified?			

#	Question	Answer	Date	Who answered (name and role)
6	What rules apply when I buy or sell for my own account?			
7	May I take a separate consulting fee from a brokerage client? What must I disclose?			

About engineering and contracting

#	Question	Answer	Date	Who answered (name and role)
8	How does my state define the practice of engineering? Does it include consultation, investigation or evaluation?			
9	How does my state define contracting? Does offering or bidding count?			
10	Which board licenses electrical, mechanical and fire protection contractors, and how do I verify a license?			

Where I verify a license in this state

License	Agency	Public search page	Date found
Professional engineer			
General or building contractor			
Electrical contractor			
Mechanical contractor			

License	Agency	Public search page	Date found
Fire protection contractor			
Real estate broker or sales associate			

Part 2. The three utility and permit questions (chapter 3)

Take these to the state utility commission's website, the serving utility and the local permitting offices.

#	Question	Answer	Date	Who answered, or which document
11	Is there a state data center law? At what size does it apply?			
12	Who regulates the serving utility?			
13	Who issues water permits?			

Notes for Part 2

- Question 11: write the size in the law's own words. Is it megawatts of total load at one location, or something else? Is the rule in force, or only proposed? A proposed term is not a rule in force. Look also for a commission rule or a utility tariff for large loads; chapter 4 shows four.
- Question 12: name the utility first, with your source. Then ask whether it is investor-owned, publicly owned or a cooperative, and which body sets its rates and service rules.
- Question 13: the answer may be a state agency, a regional district or a local utility. It can depend on where the parcel is.

For each answer, check

- ☐ I wrote the date.
- ☐ I wrote the name and role of the person, or the title and section of the document.
- ☐ I copied the rule's own words where I could.

- [ ] I did not assume another state's answer applies here.
- [ ] An attorney in this state has seen any answer I plan to rely on.